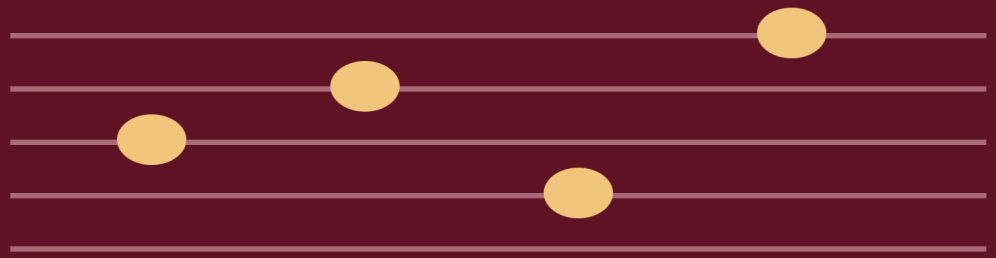
PRODUCT PITCH

TRACE

TRANSCRIBE, READ, AND CHECK BY EAR



Hear the real bass. Check the tab. Play the song.

You just want to play one song.

STEP 1
Find a YouTube tutorial

STEP 2
Google “free sheet music”

STEP 3
Find one page of it

STEP 4
Realise it’s in the wrong key

So what can you do about it?

MAYA

CASUAL GUITAR AND PIANO PLAYER

Plays for 3 years. Learns from tab sites and YouTube. Has never worked out a song by ear.

SHE WANTS

To play a song she loves now, without paying or hunting for an accurate version.

WHAT FRUSTRATES HER

Free tabs that may be wrong, paywalls on the good ones, and hours of guessing she doesn't trust.

WHAT WOULD HELP

Hearing the real bass next to the tab, so she can check it herself.

FROM THE SURVEY

33 of 47 had never tried by ear (median confidence 3 out of 10). 37 named paywalls as a frustration.

Maya is a composite built from a survey of 47 musicians, not a single interview

Maya is not the only one.

38

of 47 musicians sometimes or often can’t find an accurate version of a song

33

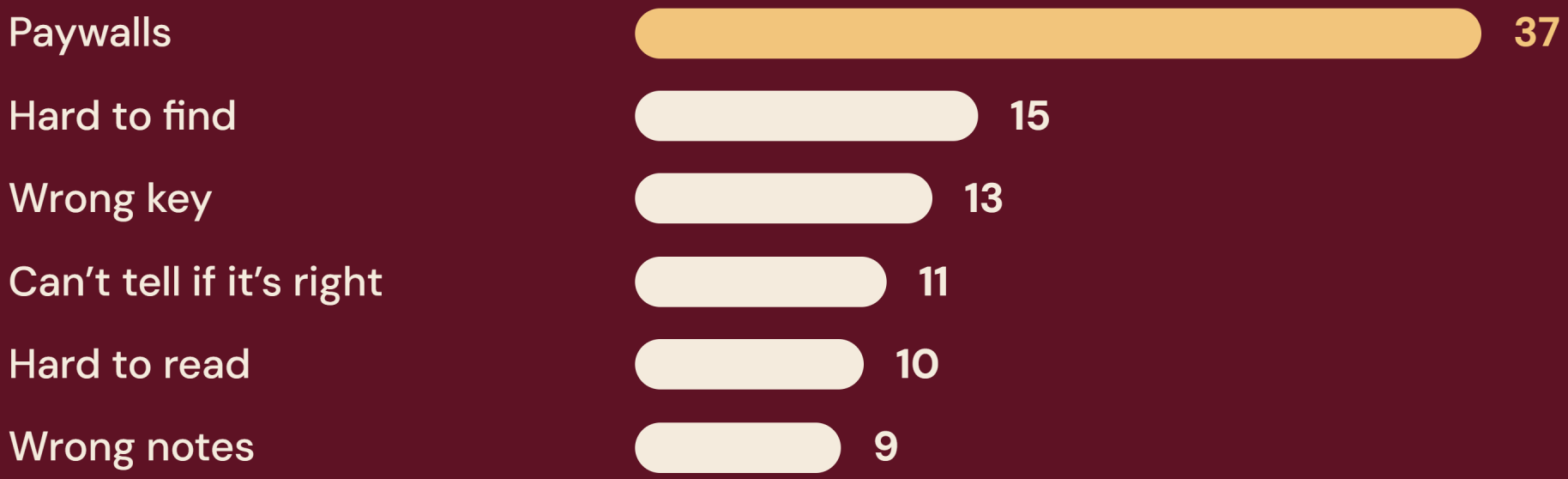
have never tried working a song out by ear. Median confidence: 3 out of 10

37

named paywalls as a frustration. The most common answer

Survey of 47 musicians, past instrument players and casual players, Oct 29 to Nov 1, 2026. My own network, so small and friendly.

What gets in the way



Out of 47 responses. People could pick more than one. Doing it by ear is not a fix: all but one of the 14 who tried took 30+ minutes for a 3 minute song.

Plenty of tabs. Nothing you can check.

TAB AND SHEET SITES

Songsterr, MuseScore, Ultimate Guitar

Lots of songs, but the good ones sit behind a paywall and you can't tell if a tab is right.

AI TRANSCRIPTION TOOLS

Songscription, Klangio

They turn audio into notes, but they don't help you check the result against the real recording.

STEM SPLITTERS

Moises

Great for hearing one instrument alone, but you still write the notes down yourself.

THE GAP

One page where the tab, the key and the real recording sit together, so you can check it by ear.

Maya’s night, before.

FIND

Searches “free tab”. Opens five sites.

HIT A WALL

The full version needs a subscription.

SETTLE

Finds a free one page sheet.

WRONG KEY

It doesn’t match the song. She can’t tell why.

GIVE UP

Closes the laptop. The song stays unplayed.

Feeling: “Is it me, or is the tab wrong?”

Maya’s night, after.

FIND

Searches the song. It’s ready, free.

SEE IT

The whole song as tab and sheet music, in the key she picks.

HEAR IT

The real bass plays while a marker follows the tab.

PRACTISE

Repeat a few bars, slow it down, keep the pitch.

TAKE IT AWAY

Prints a clean PDF to play from.

Feeling: “I can hear that it’s right.”

From a song to a page you can check.

1
Pull out the bass

2
Find the notes

3
Tidy them into tab and sheet music

4
Play it with a marker on the page

WHAT IT IS TODAY
A working prototype. One song so far, “Loser” by Tame Impala, 77 bars. Bass only.

HOW CLOSE IT IS
Matches 89% of the notes two human transcriptions agree on. Same key and tempo.

AI does the listening. I decide what's right.

DEMUCS

Separates the bass from the rest of the song.

BASIC PITCH

Spotify's model that turns the bass audio into notes.

MY OWN CODE

Cleans up the notes, finds the key, and picks where to play them on the strings.

ALPHATAB

Draws the tab and sheet music and plays the marker.

CLAUDE

Helped me build it. I chose the problem and the song, and I checked the result against two human transcriptions.

What Maya gets that she didn’t have.

NO PAYWALL

Free to start. She is never stuck behind a subscription.

THE WHOLE SONG

Every bar, not one page.

THE RIGHT KEY

The key is detected, shown, and can be changed.

CHECK BY EAR

The real bass plays next to the tab, so she can judge it herself.

EASY TO PRACTISE

Repeat bars, slow it down, tap a bar to start there.

TAKE IT AWAY

A clean PDF she can print and play from.

Honest about today. Clear about next.

TODAY

Bass only. One song. A first draft that shows the idea works.

NEXT

More songs, then guitar and piano, the instruments Maya actually plays. Drums later.

DONE RIGHT

Songs stay private by default, and I won't host full audio publicly. Licensing comes before launch.

THANK YOU

TRACE

Hear it. Check it. Play it.

github.com/SSaiyan13/trace